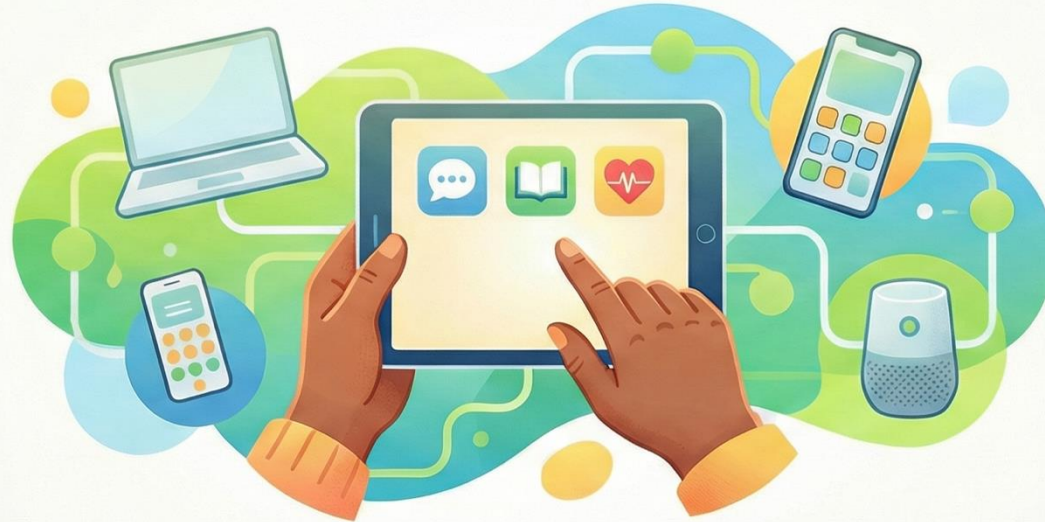


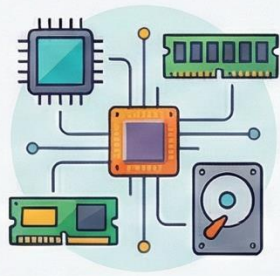
Choosing the Right Device: A Guide for Seniors



Meet Your Instructor: Jack DeVerter

Agenda

Understanding & Selecting Devices



Device Basics & Specifications

Covers understanding individual devices and their technical specifications.



Usage & Selection

Focuses on common device usage and strategies for choosing the right hardware.



Device Families

Exploring the broader categories and groups of hardware.

Specializations & Peripherals



Deep Dive: Chromebooks

A specific focus on what Chromebooks are and their unique features.



Choosing Headphones

Criteria and considerations for selecting the appropriate audio equipment.



Selecting Peripherals

Guidance on choosing additional external hardware components.

Finding the Right Device: A Simple Guide to Choosing Your Next Computer or Phone

A comparison guide to help you select the best device for your lifestyle, comfort, and needs.

The Desktop Computer (The Home Base)



A stationary computer designed to stay in one location, usually on a desk.

- Larger screen is easier on the eyes and provides more power for your money compared to other options.

Main Control Method & Power



Keyboard & Mouse



Wall Plug Only
Comfort & Power

The Laptop Computer (The Portable Choice)



- An all-in-one portable computer with screen built into one folding unit that is light enough to travel with.

- You can use it anywhere without a plug, though it needs to be recharged periodically.

- Slightly less powerful than a desktop of the same price, but includes a built-in camera and speakers for easy video calls.

Main Control Method & Power



Keyboard & Touchpad



Battery/Plug
Portability

The Hybrid Setup (Laptop + Docking Station)

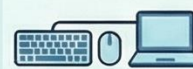


The "Best of Both Worlds" setup, using a "docking station" to connect a portable laptop to a full-sized screen and keyboard.

- Simply plug the laptop in to use it like a desktop, providing a larger screen and extra places to attach devices.

- The docking station keeps your laptop battery full while you enjoy the comfort of a full-size mouse and keyboard.

Main Control Method & Power



Keyboard, Mouse, & Touchpad



Battery/Plug
Comfort, Power & Portability

Tablets and Smartphones (Touch & Go)



Tablets: The touch-screen middle ground

- A thin, flat device (7 to 13 inches) controlled by touching and swiping the screen rather than using a mouse.
- Uses simple programs called "apps" for specific tasks and runs on a battery that lasts for several hours.



Smartphones: A computer in your pocket

- A cell phone that allows you to access the internet via Wi-Fi or cellular networks anywhere you go.
- Includes a camera, GPS for directions, and a battery that typically lasts one to two days.

Main Control Method & Power



Touchscreen



Battery
Reading, Apps & Staying Connected

Tech Made Simple: A Senior's Guide to Choosing the Right Device

THE CORE COMPONENTS (THE "INSIDE" PARTS)



PROCESSOR (CPU): THE BRAIN

The CPU follows instructions and performs calculations; higher GHz (speed) and more "cores" allow the device to handle multiple tasks at once like a team of people working together.



MEMORY (RAM): THE WORKSPACE

Think of RAM as your desk surface; more RAM (usually 8GB to 32GB) lets you keep more programs open simultaneously without the device slowing down.



STORAGE: THE FILING CABINET

Unlike RAM, storage (SSD) keeps your photos and files safe even when the power is off; it ranges from 256GB to 1TB (1,000 gigabytes).

STAYING CONNECTED

WI-FI (HOME)



Connects to a local router (like at home or a library) for free. Standard for laptops and home use.

VS.

5G (MOBILE)



Uses cell towers and requires a paid monthly data plan from a provider. Built into phones and some tablets to provide

THE VISUALS (THE SCREEN)



SIZE AND SHARPNESS

Screen size is measured diagonally (corner to corner), while resolution (pixels) determines how clear and sharp the images appear on that screen.

RESOLUTION STANDARDS



FULL HD (1920x1080) is considered a good standard for clarity.



4K ULTRA HD offers even more detail for those who want the sharpest picture.

REFRESH RATE (Hz)



This measurement tells you how smoothly movement appears on your screen, which is particularly important for watching videos or playing games.

POWER AND LONGEVITY



BATTERY CAPACITY (mAh): Measured in milliamp-hours, higher numbers generally mean the device will last longer between charges, though watching videos will drain it faster than reading.



FAST CHARGING & POWER SAVING:

Many new devices can charge to 80% in under an hour, and using 'Power Saving Mode' can help extend your usage by limiting non-essential features.



TYPICAL BATTERY LIFE EXPECTATIONS:

Expect 6–12 hours for laptops, 8–12 hours for tablets, and 1–2 days for smartphones depending on your brightness settings and app usage.

Finding Your Perfect Tech Match: A Senior's Guide to Choosing the Right Device



Desktop Computers: The Stationary Powerhouse

- ✓ **Best for Dedicated Workspaces:** Perfect for a home office or study where you can spread out and work comfortably in a consistent environment.
- ✓ **Easier on the Eyes:** Large, stationary screens make reading much easier and significantly reduce eye strain compared to smaller devices.
- ✓ **The Central Family Hub:** Ideal for a common area where multiple people can pay bills, manage photos, or look up information.



Laptop Computers: Productivity on the Go

- ✓ **Work from Anywhere:** Laptops provide the full features of a computer with the flexibility to move between rooms, libraries, or coffee shops.
- ✓ **The Ultimate Travel Companion:** Designed to work on planes and in hotels, making it easy to check emails and manage documents while away from home.
- ✓ **Presentation Ready:** Easily brought into meetings to share information on a screen larger than a phone or tablet.



Tablets: Lightweight and Versatile

- ✓ **Built for Relaxing and Reading:** Tablets are easier to hold for long periods than laptops, making them perfect for reading books or watching shows.
- ✓ **Your Digital Kitchen Assistant:** Can be propped up to display recipes while cooking, allowing you to view instructions without touching the screen with messy hands.
- ✓ **Natural Note-Taking:** Many models work with a stylus pen, allowing you to write naturally, mark up documents, or draw.



Smartphones: The All-in-One Essential

- ✓ **Constant Connection:** The primary tool for making calls, texting, and receiving instant updates like weather warnings or appointment reminders.
- ✓ **Navigation and Photography:** Includes built-in GPS for driving or walking and a high-quality camera for capturing memories without needing extra equipment.
- ✓ **Health and Safety in Your Pocket:** Features include emergency service access, a flashlight, and apps to track daily steps and exercise routines.

The Right Tool for the Job



Video Calling Options

While smartphones are good for quick calls, laptops and desktops provide the most stable, eye-level view for long family chats.



Taxes and Spreadsheets

Desktops and laptops are the best choice for detailed document work due to their full-sized keyboards and powerful software.



Complex Computing Tasks

For editing photos, videos, or managing large amounts of data, the processing power of a computer outperforms a tablet or phone.

Finding Your Perfect Tech Match: A Senior's Guide to Choosing a Device



Desktop Computers: The Home Office Hub

Best for a dedicated workspace with the largest screens and must comfortable keyboards for long sessions.



Factors for Your Comfort and Health



Vision and Screen Size: Desktops offer the largest screens for those who need high-contrast or large text.



Hand Coordination and Typing: Physical keyboards are best for arthritis or tremors.



Laptops: Power on the Move

Offers the performance of a desktop with the Revibility to move from room to room or travel.



Ergonomics and Posture: Desktops encourage better posture for long sessions, whereas extended tablet or phone use can cause neck and shoulder strain.



Tablets: The Lightweight Reader

Ideal for reading, watching videos, and simple browsing using an intuitive touchscreen interface.



Hand Coordination and Typing: Touchscreens are better for light browsing but harder for long documents.



Smartphones: The Pocket Assistant

Perfect for quick tasks, emergencies, and staying connected on the go, though they have the smallest screens.



Vision and Screen Size: Smartphones require excellent close-up vision.

Five Questions to Ask Before You Buy

1

Where will I use it most?

Choose a Desktop for one room, a Laptop for around the house, or a Smartphone for errands and travel.

2

What is my main activity?

Use Desktops/Laptops for writing and finances; Tablets for reading/videos; Smartphones for quick updates.

3

How are my eyes and hands?

Consider larger screens and external mice if you have vision challenges or hand coordination difficulties.

4

What do I already own?

A popular combination for many seniors is a Smartphone for travel plus a Desktop or Tablet for home use.

5

What is my budget?

Determine your price range and consider if spending more upfront provides better long-term value.



Smart Ways to Save
Save up to 30% by buying the previous year's models or choosing certified refurbished devices with warranties.

Budgeting for 2025

Typical Price Ranges for New Devices in 2025

Device Type	Budget-Friendly Range	Mid-Range / Reliable Range
Smartphones	\$200-\$400	\$400-\$700
Tablets	\$200-\$350	\$400-\$600
Laptops	\$400-\$700	\$700-\$1,000
Desktops	\$500-\$800	\$800-\$1,200

Finding Your Tech Family: A Simple Guide to Choosing the Right Device

The Apple Family



The Apple Lineup



This family includes the iPhone, the iPad (tablet), and Mac computers (MacBook laptops or iMac desktops).



It "Just Works" Together
Photos taken on your iPhone automatically appear on your iPad, and your contacts are shared across all devices without any extra typing.



In-Person Support
If you have a question or a problem, you can visit a physical Apple Store to talk to a real person for help.



Apple Trade-Offs
Apple products usually cost more upfront, and the system works best if you buy only Apple products rather than mixing brands.

The Android & Windows Family



The Android/Windows Lineup



This family includes phones made by Samsung, Google, or Motorola, and computers made by brands like Dell, HP, or Lenovo.



Freedom of Choice
Because many different companies make these devices, you can find a wide variety of styles and price points to fit any budget.



A Familiar Feel
If you have used a computer in an office or library before, a Windows computer will likely feel very familiar and easy to navigate.



Android/Windows Trade-Offs
Different brands may update at different times, and it can be more difficult to get your phone and computer to share information seamlessly.

Mixing and Matching



Can You Mix Families?

Yes, you can use an iPhone with a Windows computer, but it requires more manual work to move your photos and files between them.



The "Simplicity" Rule

For the easiest experience, sticking with one family for all your devices (all Apple or all Android/Windows) is highly recommended.

How to Make Your Choice



Check Your Current Gear
If you already have a Windows computer you love, an Android phone might feel more natural to you.



Look to Your Inner Circle
Consider what your friends or family use; if they have iPhones, they will be better equipped to help you learn the ropes.



The "Hands-On" Test
Visit a store and hold the devices; see which buttons feel right and which screens are easiest for you to read.

Finding Your Perfect Match: Is a Chromebook Right for You?

A Friendly Guide for Seniors on Simplicity, Benefits, and Limitations



What is a Chromebook?

An Internet-First Laptop:

Designed to work primarily online, storing your files securely in Google's cloud.



Built for Simplicity:

Starts up in under 10 seconds; as easy to use as a smartphone.



Low Maintenance & Secure:

Updates automatically and resists viruses; no manual security scans needed.

What You Can Do (and What You Can't)

PERFECT FOR EVERYDAY TASKS



Video Chat
& Connect
(Zoom/Skype)



Check Email
(Gmail)



Watch Videos
(YouTube/
Netflix)



Online
Banking



DOCS

WORKS LIKE OFFICE

Write documents and create spreadsheets using Google Docs, similar to Microsoft Office.

LIMITED OFFLINE USE



Most features require an internet connection to work effectively.



Cannot install traditional Windows or Mac software.

The Biggest Benefits



\$200 - \$600

Budget-Friendly Pricing:
More affordable than most traditional laptops.



8-12 HOURS

All-Day Battery Life:
Untethered from wall outlets for most of the day.



Automatic Backups:

Since your files are stored online, you won't lose your photos or documents if the device breaks; you can access them from any computer.

A Chromebook is Ideal If...



IDEAL IF...

- ✓ You primarily use the internet for email and social media.
- ✓ You have reliable home WiFi.
- ✓ You want a simple, affordable, low-maintenance device.



CONSIDER OTHER OPTIONS IF...

- ✗ You need specific software for a hobby.
- ✗ You have unreliable internet.
- ✗ You prefer storing large files directly on the computer's hard drive.

Sound Advice: A Senior's Guide to Choosing the Perfect Headphones

STEP 1: Prioritize Your Comfort



- **Look for Gentle Materials:** Memory foam provides cushioned support that molds to your shape, while velour fabric is soft and breathable.
- **Over-Ear is Best for Glasses:** Over-ear models go around the ears rather than pressing on them, and some even feature special cutouts for glasses frames.
- **Keep it Lightweight:** Aim for headphones weighing between 200-300 grams to prevent pressure and fatigue during extended use.

STEP 3: Master the Technology



- **Simple Wireless (Bluetooth):** Bluetooth allows your headphones to talk to your phone or tablet wirelessly; once "paired" the first time, they usually connect automatically.
- **Monitor Battery Life:** Most last 15-30 hours; look for models with USB-C charging or a backup cable to use if the battery dies.
- **Choose Active Noise Cancellation (ANC):** ANC uses microphones to cancel out steady hums like air conditioning or traffic, making it easier to bear without raising the volume to unsafe levels.



STEP 5: The Smart Shopping Checklist



- **The 10-Minute Test:** Wear headphones in the store for at least 5 to 10 minutes and walk around to ensure they stay secure and comfortable.
- **Verify Return Policies:** Look for a 14-30 day return window and keep all original packaging in case the headphones don't suit your needs at home.
- **Stick to Reliable Brands:** Brands like Sony, Bose, Sennheiser, and JBL offer clear manuals and better customer support than "no-name" brands.



STEP 2: Test for Sound Clarity

- **Use Familiar Audio:** Test headphones using a favorite song or a familiar voice recording to see if the sound feels balanced and clear.
- **Focus on "Midrange Clarity":** This ensures that voices are crisp and distinct, which is more useful for everyday listening than heavy, thumping bass.
- **Ignore the Jargon:** High numbers for "frequency response" don't always mean a better experience; trust your own ears over technical specifications.



STEP 4: Check for Accessibility



- **Physical Buttons vs. Touch Controls:** Large, tactile buttons are much easier to navigate by feel than touch-sensitive panels, especially for those with arthritis.
- **Look for Visual Cues:** Bright LED lights that indicate when the power is on, the battery is low, or the device is pairing help take the guesswork out of usage.
- **Use Voice Assistants:** Buttons that trigger Siri or Google Assistant can help you make calls or play music using just your voice.



Picking Your Perfect Pair: A Senior's Guide to Keyboards and Mice

Find comfortable, easy-to-use computer devices tailored for you. Simple, practical, and personal.

CONNECTION: Wired vs. Wireless

Wired: Simple and Reliable



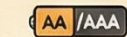
Plugs directly into USB; instant work, no batteries or issues, but cable can be tidy.

Wireless: Clean and Flexible



Uses tiny plug-and-play receiver; freedom to sit back, improves posture, no cords.

Battery Choices for Wireless



Replaceable
(Months of use)



Rechargeable
(Occasional USB charging)

MICE: Finding the Right Fit

Use a "Palm Grip" for Comfort

Most seniors find full-hand palm grip relaxing; choose a taller mouse with back support.



Mouse Sensitivity (DPI)

Higher settings make the cursor move too fast; 800-1600 DPI is easy to control.



Keep It Simple

A basic three-button mouse is usually sufficient.



Trackballs: A Great Alternative

Roll a ball with your thumb/fingers; ideal for limited space or shoulder issues.



KEYBOARDS: Visibility and Layout

High-Visibility Keys

Extra-large print or high-contrast colors make typing essier and faster for low vision.



The Benefit of Backlighting

Keys glow from underneath for easy reading in dim lighting; small extra cost.



Full-Size (17-18")



Includes number pad for banking & math.

Compact (14")



Saves desk space by removing number pad.

Focus on Simplicity



SHOPPING & VALUE

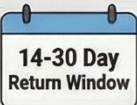
Try Before You Buy

Visit a store to feel keys and mouse; if it feels awkward, it will likely bother you at home.



Check Return Policies

Look for retailers with return windows to test in your own environment.



ERGONOMICS & COMFORT

Ergonomic Keyboards

Split or curved designs keep hands at natural width, reducing wrist strain.



Vertical Mice

Position hand in a handshake angle, significantly reducing wrist discomfort.



Use a Wrist Rest

Padded supports help reduce strain; rest wrists between typing, not while active.



Typical Price Ranges (Budgeting Guide)

Device Type	Basic Price	Premium/Ergonomic Price
Keyboard	\$15 - 225	\$60 - \$100+
Mouse	\$10 - \$15	\$30 - \$70
Combo Bundle	\$30 - \$70	N/A